as in an inclosed lattice-work, the vital organs. There are certain pieces of bone in the pelvis, face, head, and spine which are single and uniform; all the rest are arranged, like the extremities, in pairs, on either side of the body. Each pair of bones differs in some respects from every other pair, and all are fastened together by joints called articulations. The cranium is not formed of one compact mass, but consists of several pieces, firmly united by the interlocking of notched edges, called sutures. The long bones of the extremities are hard, hollow cylinders, lined with membrane, on which blood-vessels are distributed for the nutriment of their substance. The long bones are expanded at the extremities, so as to present surfaces for articulation with other bones. Some of these bones are united by a ball and socket, others by flat surfaces, but all are firmly bound together by muscles and ligaments, and the end of each bone is covered with a layer of cartilage, lubricated by means of a sac of serous membrane, which effuses a peculiar fluid, called synovia, the use of which is to keep the joints moist and supple.

The bones are composed, in the first place, of cartilage, which is converted into osseous tissue by the deposition of phosphate and carbonate of lime. In infancy, cartilaginous or animal matter constitutes the chief portion of the skeleton; in adults, the lime increases, hardening the bones, and communicating strength to the frame; in old age, however, the animal matter dissipates so rapidly that the bones become exceedingly brittle,—hence it is that fractures